

HC Services — People Code

Section 13: Employment Visa Documents Policy

Section 13.0: Document Control

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1.0	1 September 2026	—	First published edition, issued for the 2026 joining cohort.

Section 13.1: Policy Scope

This policy covers the documents a new joiner must provide so that HC Services can apply for their UAE employment visa, and how those documents are checked.

It applies **before** the employee's first day. It does not cover the renewal of an existing residence visa, the sponsorship of family members, or any matter arising after employment has begun; those are handled by People & Culture directly and are not provided for in this Code.

Section 13.2: Who This Applies To

13.2.1 Employment Status

This policy applies to a person whose employment status is **Onboarding** — an accepted offer, a start date agreed, and employment not yet commenced.

13.2.2 What Onboarding Means for Everything Else

A person who is Onboarding has not begun continuous service under HC-PC-007 §7.2. They therefore have no leave entitlement, no probation period in progress, and no expense authority. Leave begins to accrue on the first day of employment under HC-PC-001 §1.3.1, and probation begins on the same date under HC-PC-003 §3.2.1.

An Onboarding person may ask about any policy in this Code. They may not apply for leave, cancel leave, or approve anyone else's.

13.2.3 When This Policy Stops Applying

On the first day of employment the status changes to Active and this policy ceases to apply to that person.

Section 13.3: The Two Visa Routes

Which route applies is decided by the role, and is recorded against the person before the case is opened.

Route	Applies to	Academic certificate required
Employment visa — degree required	Roles whose licensing or classification requires a recognised qualification	Yes
Employment visa — no degree required	All other roles	No

13.3.1 Which Route Applies

The route is recorded on the person's case. A new joiner may ask the HCS Concierge which route applies to them rather than assuming from the table above.

Section 13.4: The Documents

13.4.1 What Is Required

Document	Required on	What it must show
Passport copy	Both routes	The full name, date of birth, nationality, passport number, place of issue, and the issue and expiry dates
Photograph	Both routes	The face, in colour, on a white background
Signed job-offer form	Both routes	The employer, the job title, the start date, and a signature with the date it was signed
Attested academic certificate	Degree route only	The awarding institution, the qualification, the date awarded, and the attestation stamps

13.4.2 How Many

Four documents on the degree route, three on the other. Nothing else is required, and a document not named above is not read.

The condition each one must satisfy is at §13.7.1.

Section 13.5: Where to Send Them

Documents are submitted through the HCS Concierge, which opens the visa document window and shows what the case still needs. A visa document is not an expense claim and is not a school document; each has its own window and its own checks.

13.5.1 Partial Submissions

Documents may be sent in parts. The case is not assessed until every document required by the route has arrived; until then the new joiner is told which are still outstanding.

Section 13.6: The Deadline

13.6.1 The 2026 Cohort

Documents for the 2026 joining cohort must be submitted by **7 October 2026**.

13.6.2 Late Submissions

A case not complete by the deadline at §13.6.1 cannot be lodged in that filing round, and the start date may be moved. Where a document cannot be obtained in time, the new joiner should tell People & Culture before the deadline rather than after it.

Section 13.7: How a Case Is Assessed

13.7.1 What Is Checked

Once every required document has arrived, the case is checked for all of the following. A document that fails a check is returned; failing one does not change the route.

Check	What it requires
Passport validity	The passport is valid for at least 6 months from the date the case is assessed. A passport with less than that must be renewed first
Photograph usable	In colour, on a white background, showing one face looking at the camera. A photograph showing more than one person is returned
Offer signed	The job-offer form issued by HC Services, signed and dated. An unsigned form is returned
Certificate attested	The academic certificate carries attestation — degree route only. A genuine certificate that is not attested is returned for attestation
Same person	Every document names the new joiner. A difference in spelling between documents is a reason to return them, because the application is made in one name
Offer is this employer	The offer is from the hiring entity. A form naming a different employer is returned

13.7.2 What Each Status Means

Status	Meaning
Awaiting Submission	One or more required documents has not arrived
Ready for the PRO	Every document has arrived and every check has passed; the case has been passed to the public relations officer to lodge

13.7.3 Who Decides

A case where every check passes is progressed without a reviewer. A case where any check fails is held and looked at by People & Culture.

Section 13.8: If Something Is Wrong

13.8.1 A Returned Document

Where a document is returned, the new joiner removes it and submits a corrected copy. The case is reassessed in full. There is no limit on the number of corrections before the deadline at §13.6.1.

13.8.2 Being Told Why

A new joiner is told which document was returned and what is wrong with it. They are not asked to guess, and they are not told a case has failed without being told which document caused it.

13.8.3 Questions and Complaints

A new joiner who disagrees with a decision under this policy may raise it with People & Culture. The grievance procedure at HC-PC-009 applies to employees; a person who has not yet started should write to People & Culture directly.

For queries about this policy, contact People & Culture at people@hcservices.ae or raise a query via the HCS Concierge.